

User Guide

Employee Experience Platform · Complete Reference

Engagement · Performance · Compensation · People Insights

Welcome to **PulseHub**, a self-contained demonstration of a modern employee-experience platform. In a single file that runs entirely in your web browser, PulseHub brings together the capabilities that leading people-management suites offer: continuous engagement measurement, recognition, goal-setting and OKRs, performance management and one-on-ones, an AI-powered Manager Agent, an always-on people-insights layer, and a full compensation-planning module — all tied together by a permission model that mirrors a real reporting hierarchy.

This guide is a complete reference. It explains what every screen does, who can see it, how the underlying concepts work, and how to get the most out of the demo. Wherever a term might be unfamiliar — compa-ratio, eNPS, pay band, flight risk — you will find a plain-language explanation, and a glossary at the end collects them all in one place.

A note on the demo

Everything you see is powered by built-in data for a fictional 15-person company led by **Janos Korognai**. No sign-up, server or internet connection is required. Actions such as posting recognition or answering a pulse take effect immediately but live only in the current browser session; reloading the page returns the demo to its starting state.

Contents

1. Introduction — what PulseHub is and who it is for
2. Getting started — opening the app, signing in, first steps
3. The demo organization — the 15 people and how they report
4. Roles & permissions — the scope model in depth
5. Navigating the interface — top bar and sidebar
6. Feature reference — every section explained
7. The Compensation module — detailed walkthrough
8. The AI assistant — how 'Run with AI' works
9. Guided walkthroughs — things to try
10. Glossary of terms
11. Frequently asked questions

1. Introduction

PulseHub is built around a simple idea: the tools a company uses to understand, develop, reward and retain its people work best when they share the same foundation. Engagement data, performance reviews, goals and pay decisions are not separate islands — they inform one another. A manager planning a merit increase should be able to see the employee's latest performance rating; an HR leader designing compensation guidelines should be able to ground them in how people are actually rated; an executive watching engagement decline should be able to trace it to a specific team and act before good people leave. PulseHub demonstrates that connected experience end to end.

The platform is organized into three broad areas that map to the sidebar. **Workspace** holds the day-to-day tools everyone touches — the dashboard, one-on-ones, goals, feedback and recognition — plus the AI Manager Agent for people leaders. **People Insights** holds the analytical and administrative surfaces — engagement reporting, the always-on AI insight layer, the executive dashboard and HR administration — which are available to managers and above for their own part of the organization. A dedicated **Compensation** area covers pay planning, benchmarking, review cycles, equity and analytics. Finally, **Integrations** shows how third-party context (for example Slack) can enrich the experience, and a **Support** area contains an in-app help guide.

Who this guide is for

Anyone exploring the demo will find this guide useful, but it is written with three audiences in mind. **Individual contributors** will learn how to answer surveys, give and receive recognition, track their own goals and prepare for one-on-ones. **People managers, VPs and the CEO** will learn how the management surfaces — the Manager Agent, engagement and AI insights, the executive view, HR administration and compensation — adapt to their level and stay scoped to the people they are responsible for. **Evaluators and stakeholders** will find the conceptual explanations and the guided walkthroughs helpful for understanding what a connected employee-experience platform can do.

How the platform 'adapts to you'

There is no single fixed layout. What you see depends entirely on who you are signed in as. An individual contributor sees a personal workspace; a manager additionally sees management tools for their team; a VP sees their whole division; the CEO sees the entire company. Understanding this role-based scope (covered in Section 4) is the key to understanding the whole product.

2. Getting started

2.1 Opening the application

PulseHub ships as a single file named **index.html**. To open it, locate the file in the folder you were given and double-click it. It will open in your computer's default web browser. Any modern browser works — Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox or Apple Safari — and no installation, plug-in or account is necessary. Because the entire application, including its data, lives inside that one file, it runs perfectly well with no internet connection; you can copy it to a USB stick, email it to a colleague, or open it on a plane, and it will behave identically.

2.2 The login screen

When PulseHub opens, it presents a login screen. This is a deliberate part of the demo: rather than silently dropping you into one fixed view, it lets you choose which person — and therefore which role and permission level — you want to experience. Because this is a demonstration, **no real password is required**. There are two ways to enter:

- **The Sign in button.** The email and password fields are pre-filled for convenience. Clicking **Sign in** logs you in as the CEO, Janos Korognai, who has full access to every part of the platform across the entire company. This is the quickest way to see everything.
- **The demo-account grid.** Below the sign-in form is a grid of all fifteen people in the organization, each shown with their name, role and job title. Click any card to enter the application as that person. This is the best way to understand how the experience changes from an individual contributor to a manager, a VP, or the CEO.

Switching accounts at any time

Once inside, you are never locked to one identity. To try a completely different person, use the **Log out** button at the very bottom of the left sidebar; this returns you to the login screen where you can pick another account. Alternatively, if you are a manager or above, the person-switcher dropdown in the top-right corner lets you move directly into anyone who reports to you (see Section 4 for exactly who that includes).

2.3 Your first few minutes

A good way to get oriented is to sign in as the CEO first and look at the sidebar: you will see every section the platform offers. Open the **Org Directory** to see the whole company laid out as a reporting chart, then click a manager's card to switch into their view and notice how the sidebar and the data narrow to just their team. Log out, sign back in as an individual contributor such as an engineer, and observe that the management surfaces disappear entirely, leaving a focused personal workspace. In three short sessions you will have seen the full range of the role-based experience.

Where does my data go?

Nowhere — it never leaves your computer. PulseHub does not transmit anything over the network. Changes you make during a session (posting recognition, answering a pulse survey, modelling a compensation scenario) are held in the browser's memory only and are cleared when you reload the page or close the tab. Every reload gives you a clean, identical starting point.

3. The demo organization

PulseHub is populated with a fictional company of fifteen people, structured as a realistic reporting hierarchy: one CEO, two vice-presidents who each lead a division, four managers who each run a team, and eight individual contributors. This structure is not merely decorative — it is the backbone of the entire application. Who reports to whom determines what each person can see, whose data a manager can act on, how engagement and compensation figures roll up, and where the boundaries of 'your team' lie. The full roster is shown below.

Name	Role	Title	Reports to	Dept
Janos Korognai	CEO	Chief Executive Officer	—	Executive
Marcus Lindqvist	VP	VP, Product & Engineering	Janos Korognai	Product
Priya Nandakumar	VP	VP, Revenue & Success	Janos Korognai	Revenue
Tomas Herrera	Manager	Engineering Manager	Marcus Lindqvist	Product
Lena Fischer	Manager	Design & Research Lead	Marcus Lindqvist	Product
Jared Whitfield	Manager	Sales Manager	Priya Nandakumar	Revenue
Sofia Marchetti	Manager	Customer Success Manager	Priya Nandakumar	Revenue
Kwame Asante	Employee	Senior Backend Engineer	Tomas Herrera	Product

Name	Role	Title	Reports to	Dept
Yuki Tanaka	Employee	Frontend Engineer	Tomas Herrera	Product
Nadia Rahman	Employee	Product Designer	Lena Fischer	Product
Oliver Bennett	Employee	UX Researcher	Lena Fischer	Product
Camila Rojas	Employee	Account Executive	Jared Whitfield	Revenue
Derek O'Sullivan	Employee	Sales Development Rep	Jared Whitfield	Revenue
Fatima Al-Sayed	Employee	Customer Success Specialist	Sofia Marchetti	Revenue
Ethan Park	Employee	Support & Onboarding	Sofia Marchetti	Revenue

The company has two divisions. **Product**, led by VP Marcus Lindqvist, contains the Engineering team under Tomas Herrera (with engineers Kwame Asante and Yuki Tanaka) and the Design & Research team under Lena Fischer (with designer Nadia Rahman and researcher Oliver Bennett). **Revenue**, led by VP Priya Nandakumar, contains the Sales team under Jared Whitfield (with Camila Rojas and Derek O'Sullivan) and the Customer Success team under Sofia Marchetti (with Fatima Al-Sayed and Ethan Park). You can explore this structure interactively at any time in the Org Directory, which draws the chart and lets you jump into anyone you have permission to view.

4. Roles & permissions

PulseHub's single most important concept is **role-based scope**. Every screen, every list of people, and every number you see is filtered to match who you are and what you are responsible for. This mirrors how a real organization handles sensitive people-data: an individual contributor should not see a colleague's salary or engagement scores; a manager should see their own team but not a peer manager's; a VP should see their division; and only the CEO should see everything. Understanding this model makes the rest of the product intuitive.

4.1 The four roles

- **Individual contributor (Employee).** Has a personal workspace: their own dashboard, one-on-ones, goals, feedback and recognition, plus the ability to answer engagement surveys and view the company org chart. Does not have access to management or analytical surfaces.
- **Manager.** Everything an employee has, plus the AI Manager Agent and the People Insights and Compensation surfaces — all scoped to their own direct and indirect reports (their team).
- **VP.** The same management capabilities as a manager, but scoped to their entire division: their managers and all of those managers' people.
- **CEO.** Full access across the whole company. Because everyone ultimately reports up to the CEO, the CEO's 'team' is the entire organization.

4.2 What 'scope' means in practice

'Scope' is the set of people you are responsible for, computed by walking down the reporting chart from you to the bottom. For an individual contributor that set is just themselves. For a manager it is their direct reports. For a VP it is every person beneath them — their managers and those managers' reports. For the CEO it is all fourteen other people. Scope governs three things: which people appear in analytical reports (engagement, AI insights, executive metrics), whose pay you can plan in the Compensation module, and who you can 'become' using the person switcher. It is why VP Marcus, for example, sees engagement and compensation for the Product division only, never for Revenue.

4.3 The permission matrix

The table below summarizes what each role can access. 'Team', 'Division' and 'Company' indicate the scope of the data shown, not merely whether the screen is visible.

Capability	Employee	Manager	VP	CEO
Personal Dashboard	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Answer pulse surveys	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Give & receive recognition	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Own goals, 1-on-1s, feedback	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
View the org chart	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Manager Agent (AI)	—	Yes	Yes	Yes
Engagement reports	—	Team	Division	Company
AI Insights	—	Team	Division	Company
Executive Dashboard	—	Team	Division	Company
HR Administrator	—	Team	Division	Company

Capability	Employee	Manager	VP	CEO
Compensation module	—	Team	Division	Company
Switch into other people	Self	Self + reports	Division	Everyone

The org chart is the one universal screen

Notice that the Org Directory is visible to everyone at full company scope. The reasoning is that a reporting chart is not sensitive — knowing who reports to whom helps everyone navigate the organization. However, being able to **act as** another person is still restricted: on the chart, your own card is highlighted, the cards of people you may switch into are clickable, and everyone else's card is shown but dimmed and marked 'outside your access'.

Why individual contributors don't see People Insights or Compensation

These are management and administrative tools that expose aggregated engagement data and individual pay information. Restricting them to people leaders protects colleagues' privacy and reflects how such data is governed in practice. Individual contributors still participate fully — they answer the surveys that feed engagement reports and receive the pay decisions made in compensation cycles — they simply don't administer them.

5. Navigating the interface

PulseHub's layout is consistent on every screen: a fixed sidebar on the left for navigation, a top bar for identity and search, and the main content area in the centre.

5.1 The top bar

- **Page title and subtitle** (left) tell you which screen you are on.
- **Search box** is a demonstration placeholder for finding people and goals.
- **Person switcher** (right) is the dropdown that lets you move into another identity. It only lists people within your scope — yourself plus anyone who reports to you — and choosing someone instantly re-renders the whole application as that person. The label '(you)' marks your current selection.
- **Role pill** beneath the switcher shows the current person's role and department at a glance.

5.2 The sidebar

Navigation is grouped into labelled sections. Managers and above see all of them; individual contributors see a reduced set, and any group whose items are all hidden is omitted entirely so there are never empty headings. Items marked with a small **AI** tag use the generative assistant, and the **Slack AI** item carries a **2026** tag to indicate a forward-looking integration.

Sidebar group	Sections it contains	Audience
Workspace	Dashboard, Manager Agent, 1-on-1s, Goals & OKRs, Feedback, Recognition	Everyone (Manager Agent: managers +)
People Insights	Engagement, AI Insights, Executive, HR Admin, Directory	Managers + (Directory: everyone)
Compensation	Compensation	Managers +
Integrations	Slack AI	Everyone (demo)
Support	Help & Guide	Everyone

At the very bottom of the sidebar sits the **Log out** button, which returns you to the login screen. There is also a short reminder that you can switch person from the top bar and that the interface adapts to each role.

In-app help is always available

Everything in this printed guide is also summarized inside the product under **Support** → **Help & Guide**. That page is personalized: it greets you by name, states your current role and what you can access, and explains each menu item with a note on who can see it. It is the fastest way to orient a new user who is already in the app.

6. Feature reference

This section documents every screen in PulseHub. Each entry states who can see it, explains what it does and why, and describes the actions available. Screens that expose team data are always scoped to your reporting line as described in Section 4.

6.1 Dashboard

Who sees it: Everyone (content adapts to role)

The Dashboard is your landing page and a personalized summary of what matters right now. For an **individual contributor** it shows a warm greeting, the progress of their own goals, how much recognition they have received this quarter, when their next one-on-one is scheduled and with whom, and this week's pulse-survey questions ready to answer inline. It is designed so that a busy IC can see their standing and take the one or two actions expected of them in under a minute.

For a **manager, VP or CEO**, the Dashboard instead leads with team-level signals: headcount and number of direct reports, the team's engagement score with its month-over-month change, how many people are flagged as at-risk and need follow-up, and how many action items across the team are overdue. It surfaces a one-click **Manager daily briefing** — an AI summary of the day — and shows a snapshot of team engagement metrics and recent recognition. From here a leader can jump straight into the Manager Agent or give recognition.

Tip. Sign in as an engineer and then as a manager and compare the two dashboards side by side to feel how the product re-shapes itself around your responsibilities.

6.2 Manager Agent

Who sees it: Managers, VPs, CEO

The Manager Agent is an always-on AI assistant built specifically for people leaders. Its guiding principle is that recommendations should be **grounded in employee data rather than the manager's memory**: every draft it produces is assembled from the selected person's goals, tenure, recognition history, peer feedback and engagement signals. At the top of the screen a **Focus** selector chooses which team member the actions apply to, and three quick buttons offer the day's most common tasks: the daily briefing, preparing tomorrow's one-on-ones, and reviewing overdue items.

The actions are organized into two groups. **Daily manager productivity** covers ten everyday tasks: prepare tomorrow's one-on-ones, draft a meeting agenda, summarize an employee's history, highlight overdue action items, recommend coaching topics, suggest recognition opportunities, identify employees needing follow-up, summarize the last performance review, prepare a quarterly review, and draft difficult feedback (using a supportive Situation–Behavior–Impact structure). **Performance management** covers ten review-cycle tasks: draft an annual review, draft a mid-year review, summarize peer feedback, compare goals against achievements, recommend development areas, identify strengths, build an improvement plan, track review completion, provide calibration support, and surface manager reminders.

Each action opens a panel that briefly shows 'Analyzing people data...' and then presents an editable draft. Individual contributors do not have this tool; if one navigates to it they see a friendly explanation that it is reserved for people managers.

Tip. The Focus selector is the key. Change it to a different report and re-run the same action to see how the output is tailored to each person.

6.3 1-on-1 Meetings

Who sees it: Everyone

One-on-ones are where managers and their reports stay aligned, and PulseHub treats agenda preparation and context-gathering as first-class features. Managers pick a report and can generate a full set of meeting artefacts: an agenda built from current context, a recap of the previous meeting, the list of outstanding action items, likely employee concerns drawn from survey and Slack signals, career and growth prompts, coaching suggestions, auto-captured notes, a one-glance AI summary, and action tracking that shows the closure rate over time.

Individual contributors see their own upcoming one-on-one with their manager and can use the same tools to prepare their side of the conversation. A weekly one-on-one history is shown with the status of past meetings so nothing falls through the cracks.

6.4 Goals & OKRs

Who sees it: Everyone (team rollups for managers)

This screen is where objectives are created, aligned and tracked from the individual level all the way up to company goals. Anyone can view and manage their own objectives, complete with key results and progress bars. Managers additionally get a rollup of their team's goals so they can see at a glance who is on track and who is behind.

The AI actions here help with the mechanics of good goal-setting: drafting an OKR from team priorities, cascading a department goal into team objectives, checking alignment so that individual goals ladder up to company objectives, spotting missed milestones and explaining why, and surfacing reminders for check-ins that are due.

6.5 Feedback

Who sees it: Everyone

The Feedback screen brings continuous feedback and development conversations into one place. It supports in-the-moment feedback nudges, peer and manager recognition, private coaching notes, anonymous feedback with the identity protected, a feedback history timeline for a person, and trend analysis showing how feedback volume and sentiment are moving over time. The intent is to make feedback a continuous habit rather than a once-a-year event.

6.6 Recognition (Good Vibes)

Who sees it: Everyone

Recognition is the single strongest driver of engagement, and PulseHub makes it effortless. From the Recognition screen anyone can write a 'Good Vibe' — a public shout-out — choose the colleague, tag it with company values such as Ownership or Customer-first, and post it to the company feed. The page also shows a recognition leaderboard of the most-appreciated people this quarter and a personal summary of what you have given and received.

Recognition you post appears in the feed immediately. Like all demo interactions, these additions are kept only for the current browser session.

6.7 Employee Engagement

Who sees it: Managers, VPs, CEO (scoped to their teams)

The Engagement screen is the reporting home for the pulse-survey programme. It leads with the headline numbers — an overall engagement score out of ten, participation rate, and eNPS — and then breaks performance down across fifteen engagement metrics: Recognition, Feedback, Team happiness, Wellness/burnout, Relationship with manager, Relationship with peers, Alignment, Ambassadorship (eNPS), Career growth, Autonomy & satisfaction, Psychological safety, Work-life balance, Leadership trust,

Remote/collaboration, and Change readiness. Each metric shows its current value and the change since last period.

Four tabs organize the detail. **The 15 metrics** lists them all with trend arrows. **Engagement heatmap** shows a teams-by-metrics grid where red cells flag areas needing attention. **Surveys** covers survey scheduling and comment summarization. **Burnout & wellness** is a dedicated monitor that watches workload and sentiment signals and recommends action. Everything is scoped: a manager sees only their team, a VP only their division.

Individual contributors do not see this reporting screen, but they are its foundation — they answer the anonymous pulse surveys (on their Dashboard) that produce every number here. A minimum response threshold protects anonymity so that small teams cannot be de-anonymized.

6.8 AI Insights

Who sees it: Managers, VPs, CEO (scoped)

AI Insights is an ‘always-on’ layer that continuously analyzes people data and surfaces proactive recommendations, so leaders do not have to go looking for problems. It offers twelve insight types: summarize survey comments, detect recurring themes, identify engagement risks, flag declining morale, recommend manager actions, identify recognition gaps, highlight high performers, detect flight-risk indicators, compare departments, produce a weekly executive summary, generate a manager daily briefing, and present a team-health dashboard.

Each insight is scoped to your reporting line, so a VP’s ‘compare departments’ view shows only the teams in their division. The intent is to shorten the distance between a signal (say, wellness dipping during a product launch) and an action (protecting focus time for that team).

6.9 Executive Dashboard

Who sees it: Managers, VPs, CEO (scoped)

The Executive Dashboard is a leadership-level view of organizational health. It presents org health, attrition trend, goal completion and the number of high-risk teams as headline figures, then breaks down engagement by department, the distribution of performance ratings across the population, and a manager-effectiveness ranking. A one-click generator produces a board-ready summary. As with the other insight surfaces, the data is scoped to the signed-in leader’s part of the organization.

6.10 HR Administrator

Who sees it: Managers, VPs, CEO (scoped)

The HR Administrator screen holds the operational tools for running people programmes: creating and scheduling surveys, configuring review cycles and calibration, tracking manager review compliance, and viewing adoption and leadership reporting. It is where the cadences that feed the rest of the platform — weekly pulses, quarterly manager surveys, the annual engagement survey and the mid-year review cycle — are defined.

6.11 Org Directory

Who sees it: Everyone

The Org Directory renders the full company as an interactive reporting chart and is the one analytical screen visible to everyone. Your own card is highlighted. Cards you are permitted to switch into are clickable; every other card is shown but dimmed and labelled ‘outside your access’, so the structure is always transparent even though the ability to act as someone remains controlled. If the chart is wider than your screen it scrolls horizontally.

6.12 Slack AI

Who sees it: Everyone (demo integration)

Slack AI illustrates how real-time context from a chat platform can enrich the employee experience. A live-looking channel feed is paired with ten AI actions: summarize Slack discussions, identify project blockers, build performance-review evidence from Slack contributions, detect engagement signals, answer HR-policy questions, retrieve knowledge, prepare for meetings using Slack context, surface coaching opportunities, recommend follow-up actions, and find organizational knowledge. It demonstrates the principle that performance and engagement insights are richer when they draw on where work actually happens.

6.13 Help & Guide

Who sees it: Everyone

The in-app Help & Guide mirrors this document in a personalized, always-current form. It greets you by name, states your role and exactly what you can access, walks through getting started, and describes every menu item with a note on who can see it, followed by key concepts and a role breakdown. It is the quickest way for a new user to get their bearings without leaving the app.

7. The Compensation module

Compensation is one of the most consequential and sensitive areas of people management, and PulseHub dedicates a full module to it. Like the other management surfaces it is available to managers and above and is strictly scoped to your reporting line — a manager plans pay for their own team, a VP for their division, and the CEO for the whole company. Its defining characteristic is that it is **linked to performance**: merit and promotion recommendations are driven by each person's latest review rating, managers can see performance while they plan increases, and HR can build guidelines directly from ratings. The module is organized into five tabs.

7.1 Planning & bands

A **salary band** is the pay range for a given level of role: a minimum, a mid-point (the market-competitive target for a fully-performing person) and a maximum. Bands keep pay consistent and explainable. PulseHub defines five bands, from individual contributor up to executive, shown below in US-dollar base terms.

Band	Level	Minimum	Mid-point	Maximum
E5	Executive	\$320,000	\$400,000	\$480,000
D4	VP	\$200,000	\$250,000	\$300,000
C3	Manager	\$130,000	\$160,000	\$190,000
B2	Senior IC	\$95,000	\$120,000	\$145,000
A1	IC	\$70,000	\$90,000	\$110,000

The Planning tab summarizes the population in scope — how many people, how many distinct bands are in use, the split between salaried and hourly pay structures, and how many geographic zones and currencies are represented. It then visualizes each band as a horizontal range with every employee plotted as a coloured dot at their position within the band, making outliers easy to spot at a glance. Below that, a per-employee table lists salary, band and **compa-ratio**.

What is a compa-ratio?

Compa-ratio is an employee's salary divided by the mid-point of their band, expressed as a percentage. A compa-ratio of 100% means the person is paid exactly at the market target for their level; below about 90% suggests they may be underpaid for their role; above about 110% suggests they are high in the band, which is normal for top performers but worth watching. PulseHub colour-codes the figure so you can scan a team quickly.

PulseHub also supports the realities of a distributed workforce: **multiple pay structures** (salaried employees show an annual figure; hourly employees show an hourly rate), **multiple currencies** (US dollars, euros and British pounds are represented, each shown with its own symbol and converted amount), and **geographic pay zones** such as US-National, EU-West, UK and Remote-US. This lets a single band framework be applied fairly across locations.

7.2 Salary benchmarking

Internal consistency is only half the picture; pay must also be competitive externally. The Benchmarking tab compares internal median pay against market rates for each level, using built-in market data attributed to **Mercer**, a well-known compensation-survey provider. Each level shows the internal median beside the market figure and a percentage indicating how internal pay compares, colour-coded so that anything meaningfully below market is flagged. A summary panel counts how many people sit at or above market and how many fall below, and the tab includes an option to **import third-party benchmark data** so that multiple survey sources can be blended. In the demo the figures are illustrative.

7.3 Compensation reviews and the sandbox

The Review-cycle tab is where annual merit increases and promotions are planned. It opens with the cycle's financials: the merit budget (modelled here as four percent of the base payroll in scope), the forecast spend under the current plan, the resulting percentage of budget consumed, and the average increase. A colour badge tells you at a glance whether the plan is within or over budget.

The heart of this tab is **Sandbox mode**, which lets you model different scenarios before committing to anything. Four scenarios are provided and switch instantly:

Scenario	How increases are calculated
Guideline (performance)	Each person's increase follows the merit matrix driven by their review rating.
Flat 3%	A uniform three-percent increase for everyone.
Flat 4%	A uniform four-percent increase for everyone.
Budget-constrained	Guideline amounts scaled back to fit tighter budget limits.

As you switch scenarios the merit table, the forecast spend and the budget indicator all recompute immediately, so you can weigh the trade-off between rewarding performance and staying within budget. The **performance link** is visible right in the planning table: every person's current review rating is shown next to their proposed increase, because ratings drive the guideline amounts. The underlying merit matrix is:

Performance rating	Guideline annual increase
Exceeds expectations	6.0%
Strongly meets expectations	4.5%
Meets expectations	3.0%
Developing	1.5%

Nothing is final until it is approved. A four-step **approval workflow** — manager proposals, HR review, finance and budget sign-off, and launch & communicate — is shown with the status of each stage, and a 'Launch review cycle' action stands in for kicking off the process. The ability to forecast spending and model scenarios **before** launching is precisely what keeps a cycle affordable and defensible.

7.4 Pay equity

The Pay-equity tab helps ensure compensation is fair and consistent. It surfaces four things. **Band adherence** is the share of employees whose pay sits within their band's minimum and maximum. **Below-band** and **above-band** lists identify individuals who fall outside their range and therefore warrant a deliberate decision — a below-band employee may need an adjustment, while an above-band employee is often a strong performer to review at promotion time. **Pay compression** detection flags cases where a manager is paid only marginally more than a report, which can happen when market rates rise faster than existing salaries. Finally, an illustrative **adjusted pay gap** figure stands in for the kind of statistical analysis a real deployment performs across demographic groups, controlling for role, level, location and tenure.

7.5 Analytics

The Analytics tab is the compensation dashboard. It reports total base compensation spend, average compa-ratio across the team, band adherence, and the merit budget. It tracks the merit cycle's forecast, committed and remaining budget, and shows a trend of average compa-ratio across recent review cycles. Two AI actions are available here: one drafts compensation guidelines directly from the performance-rating matrix, and one produces a plain-language summary of pay equity and band adherence.

Why linking Performance and Compensation matters

Keeping performance and pay in separate systems forces managers to reconcile them from memory at review time, which is slow and error-prone. By linking them, PulseHub lets a manager see the rating while proposing the increase, lets HR encode a consistent pay-for-performance policy once and apply it everywhere, and lets finance forecast the cost before anyone is promised anything. That connection is the module's biggest differentiator.

8. The AI assistant

Throughout PulseHub you will encounter tiles and buttons labelled **Run with AI** or marked with a small AI badge. They embody a consistent idea: routine people-management writing and analysis — drafting a review, summarizing feedback, recommending a coaching topic, explaining a pay gap — can be accelerated by an assistant that is grounded in the relevant data. Clicking any AI tile opens a panel that briefly shows ‘Analyzing people data...’ and then presents a generated draft or recommendation.

How to use an AI action

- **Open it.** Click any AI tile or button. A modal panel appears with the result.
- **Understand the grounding.** Every output is assembled from the current person’s data — their goals, tenure, recognition, peer feedback and engagement signals — not invented from nothing. The panel footer reminds you that output is grounded in employee data, not memory.
- **Regenerate or copy.** Use **Regenerate** to produce a fresh take, **Copy** to grab the text, and the × to close.
- **Set the focus.** In the Manager Agent and one-on-ones, the Focus selector controls which team member the actions are about; in Compensation the actions apply to your scoped team.

This is a demonstration

The AI output in this demo is illustrative sample text generated locally to convey the experience. It is not a live language model, and nothing you do is sent anywhere — it all runs inside the single HTML file on your computer.

9. Guided walkthroughs

A few short scenarios show the platform at its best.

Walkthrough 1 — Experience the role model

Sign in as the CEO and open the Org Directory to see the whole company. Click VP Marcus Lindqvist’s card to become him, and notice the sidebar and every report narrow to the Product division. Click Engineering Manager Tomas Herrera to narrow further to just his two engineers. Finally log out and sign in as engineer Yuki Tanaka to see the focused individual-contributor workspace with the management surfaces gone. This is the fastest way to internalize how scope works.

Walkthrough 2 — Prepare for a one-on-one with the Manager Agent

As a manager, open the Manager Agent, set the Focus selector to one of your reports, and run ‘Draft meeting agenda’. Review the generated agenda, then run ‘Summarize employee history’ and ‘Recommend coaching topics’ for the same person. Change the Focus to a different report and re-run to see the output adapt.

Walkthrough 3 — Model a merit cycle

As a manager or the CEO, open Compensation and go to the Review-cycle tab. Note the forecast spend and budget indicator under the default performance-based guideline. Switch the sandbox to ‘Flat 4%’ and watch the numbers and budget badge change; try ‘Budget-constrained’ to see how staying within budget affects individual increases. Observe that each person’s review rating sits beside their proposed increase — the performance link in action.

Walkthrough 4 — Check pay equity

In Compensation, open the Pay-equity tab and read the band-adherence figure, then look at anyone flagged below or above band and any compression warnings. Switch to Analytics and run the ‘Draft comp guidelines’ AI action to see how a consistent policy can be generated from performance ratings.

10. Glossary of terms

Band (salary band)	The pay range for a level of role, defined by a minimum, mid-point and maximum.
Compa-ratio	Salary divided by the band mid-point, as a percentage. 100% means paid at the market target.
Merit increase	A pay rise awarded in a review cycle, typically sized by performance rating.
Merit budget	The pool of money available for increases in a cycle; here modelled as 4% of base payroll.
Sandbox mode	A way to model compensation scenarios and see the cost before committing to them.
Pay compression	When a manager is paid only marginally more than a report, often due to rising market rates.
Band adherence	The share of employees whose pay sits within their band's range.
Pay zone	A geographic pricing area (e.g., US-National, EU-West) used to localize pay fairly.
eNPS	Employee Net Promoter Score — how likely people are to recommend the company as a place to work.
Pulse survey	A short, frequent, anonymous survey used to track engagement continuously.
Engagement metric	One of fifteen dimensions (e.g., Recognition, Wellness, Alignment) that make up the engagement score.
OKR	Objectives and Key Results — a goal (objective) with measurable results that define success.
Flight risk	A signal that an employee may be at risk of leaving, based on sentiment and other data.
Calibration	A process of comparing ratings across teams to keep them fair and consistent.
Scope	The set of people you are responsible for, from you down the reporting chart to the bottom.
Compa (market) benchmark	External market pay data (here from Mercer) used to keep pay competitive.

11. Frequently asked questions

Do I need to install anything or be online?	No. PulseHub is a single HTML file that runs fully offline in any modern browser.
How do I change which role I'm experiencing?	Log out from the bottom of the sidebar and pick a different demo account, or — if you are a manager or above — use the top-bar switcher to move into one of your reports.
Why can't I see Engagement, Compensation or AI Insights as an employee?	Those are management surfaces, available to managers and above for their own team. Employees still answer pulse surveys, receive pay decisions, and can view the org chart.
I posted recognition or answered a pulse and it disappeared after reload.	Demo changes are held only for the current browser session and reset when you reload the page.

Is any of the data real?	No. All fifteen people, every metric, all pay figures and all AI output are fictional and for demonstration only.
How is compensation connected to performance?	Merit-increase guidelines are driven by each person's review rating, ratings are shown while planning increases, and guidelines can be generated from the rating matrix.
The org chart is wider than my screen.	It scrolls horizontally. The whole company is always shown; the people you can switch into are clickable and everyone else is dimmed.
Can I see a colleague's pay or engagement scores?	Only if they are within your scope (i.e., they report to you). The permission model prevents peers and reports from seeing upward or sideways.

PulseHub — interactive demo. Inspired by modern employee-experience tooling; all names, data, market benchmarks and AI output are fictional and illustrative. Built as a single self-contained HTML file that runs entirely in your browser. This guide reflects the demo led by Janos Korognai.